

A Great Tit feeds its chicks. If breeding takes place after the peak period for spring caterpillars, there will be less food for the young birds, and fewer will survive to breed.

“We are now sure of what we only suspected years ago. Policy needs to catch up with science.”

Camille Parmesan

Taking action

All of this disturbing evidence has prompted climate scientists worldwide to lobby governments and demand policy change. Spring creep has been used by scientists as a definitive piece of proof that climate change is occurring, and researchers have called upon policy makers to fight global warming to save the familiar species that find their very existence threatened by phenological changes.